Fionnuala Brannigan

Site Reliability Engineer

fionnuala.brannigan@example.org · Cork, Ireland

SUMMARY

SRE focused on reliability targets, observability and boring, repeatable operations. I have spent eight years moving teams from heroics to SLOs. Day to day I work on GKE, OpenTofu modules and GitLab pipelines, and I enjoy writing blameless postmortems more than I probably should. I am equally comfortable in front of a dashboard at 3am and in a room explaining reliability trade-offs to product managers, and I mentor junior engineers on incident response.

SKILLS

GCP, GKE, OpenTofu, GitLab CI, SLOs and error budgets, OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Loki, Go, Python, Cloud Run, PagerDuty

EXPERIENCE

Site Reliability Engineer, Harrowgate Payments 2021 – Present

- Defined SLOs for 25 customer-facing services and introduced error-budget reviews that cut paging noise by 45%.
- Maintain the GKE estate (autopilot and standard) and a library of OpenTofu modules shared across six squads.
- Own the GitLab CI templates that build, scan, sign and promote container images to production.
- Led a zero-downtime migration of the primary database to a regional replica topology.
- Introduced load-testing before major launches; found a connection pool limit that would have caused an outage during the spring promotion.
- Wrote the incident response playbook, with clear roles for commander, scribe and communications lead.

Infrastructure Engineer, Maple & Quay Software 2018 – 2021

- Managed VM fleets on GCP and later moved workloads to GKE with Helm charts.
- Built reusable infrastructure-as-code modules for networks and IAM, later ported to OpenTofu.
- Set up centralised logging and dashboards that the support team still uses.
- Reduced alert volume by consolidating 300 rules into 90 symptom-based ones.
- Trained eight developers to carry their own pager for the services they own.

Junior Systems Engineer, Corrib Data Services 2016 – 2018

- Handled tickets, patching and backups for managed hosting customers.
- Wrote monitoring checks and a first set of Ansible playbooks.
- Wrote Python scripts that checked backup integrity and reported failures to chat.

EDUCATION

- BSc Computing, Lough Mhor Institute of Technology (2012 – 2016)

LANGUAGES

English (native), Irish (conversational)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect